

C:1

Camptown Races

Arranged by Robin Proctor

Stephen C. Foster

Allegretto ♩ = c.96

5 2 1

5 2 1

9 4 2 2 2

f *mp*

marcato 3 2

14 3 1 5 3

f

gva 1 3

The American songwriter Stephen C. Foster (1826–64), who was largely self-taught as a musician, composed about 200 songs between 1844 and 1864. About 30 of these, including the popular *Camptown Races* of 1850, are minstrel songs with choral refrains, originally sung by the celebrated Christy Minstrels. The first verse and refrain of *Camptown Races* read:

De Camptown ladies sing dis song – Doo-dah! doo-dah!
 De Camptown race-track five miles long – Oh! doo-dah day!
 I come down dah wid my hat caved in – Doo-dah! doo-dah!
 I go back home wid a pocket full of tin – Oh! doo-dah day!

Gwine to run all night! Gwine to run all day!
 I'll bet my money on de bobtail nag – Somebody bet on de bay.

The song is given here in a piano arrangement for the black keys only. For fun (outside the exam) it would be worth trying it on the white keys in G major.